



WordPress



Group Micro-blogging Using WordPress

To all the Net savvy social animals out there with a Twitter, Facebook, G+ and a whole lot of StumbleUpon accounts, here is a more exciting way to get going with your latest project.

Last month, I was stuck with a problem. I am part of a team of FOSS enthusiasts, who all work on various projects, and we are spread across different time-zones and locations. We usually have meet-ups every week and are in constant discussions online, which is via a mailing list or Skype. All of us know each other. Each of us mentors some new students on our campus, too. And the newbies start off contributing to FOSS, discussing on mailing lists... and so the story has been going on for some time. But then we discovered that there was a huge lack of communication between the people inside our group itself. We created a Facebook group, but that became too social, and less developer-oriented.

After trying out many other alternatives, we stumbled upon a similar problem faced by Automattic—the team behind WordPress. And they had come up with their own

solution for this problem—p2.

p2 is a group micro-blogging theme introduced by WordPress. To quote the theme page, "... p2 transforms a mild-mannered blog into a super-blog with features like in-line comments on the homepage, a posting form right on the homepage, in-line editing of posts and comments, real-time updates so new posts and comments come in without reloading, and much more."

What does p2 do best?

This is for teams, an organisation, an interest group or a club. p2 packs in features reminiscent of Twitter and Facebook, but with a much more inherently blogging environment. The WordPress development team uses p2 for its discussions (<http://wpdevel.wordpress.com/>) too.



Figure 1: p2-home



Figure 2: p2-comments